

Bad Bunny: Puerto Rican Global Superstar [C1]

È stato l'artista più ascoltato nel 2025. La sua musica, influenzata dallo stile portoricano, è un simbolo di rivendicazione delle proprie origini.



Benito Antonio Martínez Ocasio, better known as Bad [Bunny](#), has become an icon on the global music scene and a symbol of pride for Puerto Rican people around the world. The singer made history at the 2023 Grammy Awards when his fourth album “Un Verano Sin Ti” won Best Música Urbana Album and became the first Spanish-language album ever nominated for Album of the Year. In January 2025, he released “DeBÍ TiRAR MÁS FOToS”, a deeply personal and political project recorded in Puerto Rico. The album [blends](#) reggaeton with traditional island sounds like plena, jíbaro, salsa, and bomba, and explores themes of cultural identity, political resistance, and nostalgia.

NUYORICAN

[True to form](#), Bad [Bunny](#) used the [release date](#) of this album to make a political and cultural [statement](#). While albums are typically released on Fridays, Bad [Bunny](#) made the decision to release his album on Sunday 5 January, one day before Three Kings Day, an important celebration for the people of Puerto Rico and the rest of the Spanish-speaking world. Places

Puerto Rico: Disaster, Neglect, And The Fight For Statehood Gli uragani del 2017 non hanno solo devastato Porto Rico, ma hanno anche messo in evidenza la fragilità delle sue infrastrutture e riaperto i dibattiti su identità, disuguaglianza e status politico. Molly Malcolm Despite having lived all his life in Puerto Rico, an [unincorporated territory](#) of the United States, Bad [Bunny](#) is [heir](#) to the strong Puerto Rican musical tradition in the US, and in particular in New York, due to large-scale immigration from the island to New York City, especially after the Second World War. The term ‘Nuyorican’ emerged in the mid-1960s in reference to Puerto Ricans who lived, grew up or were born in New York City. In the past, this term was often used negatively, denoting the use of Spanglish or a lost connection to Puerto Rico. As time went by, however, this term began to reflect an entire cultural movement, characterized by its own dialect and a celebration of Afro-Caribbean and indigenous [heritage](#), and it became a symbol of pride and resistance instead of a [token](#) of humiliation.

SHOULD’VE TAKEN MORE PICTURES

In an interview with Apple Music to promote his album “DeBÍ TiRAR MÁS FOToS”, Bad [Bunny](#) reflected on his career, challenges in life, family and his ultimate goal when making music. He began by talking about the changes that he’s experienced due to his rising fame and how this has altered his perspective on life and being Puerto Rican. Being a non-native speaker, he makes plenty of grammar mistakes and sometimes reverts to using Spanish. **Bad [Bunny](#) (Puerto Rican accent):** There’s [are] a lot of things that I now really appreciate more than before. I’ve been living a lot of new experiences. The last two years, I met a lot of people from different countries, from different cultures, and I had to share my culture and

my... circunstancias de lo que se vive aquí en Puerto Rico. It's not the same to talk to another Puerto Rican about Puerto Rico or with another Latino, but talk to people from USA, from Canada, from Russia, from Germany about your country. And see how people react to the things that you are telling to them [telling them] is [mind-blowing](#)... and all that [those] things made me think about who I am and what I really represent. [Cause](#) I represent my country, my people around the world, but now I have another [purpose](#). You know what I mean? Being here was my dream, but I was asking to myself [asking myself], what is the reason to me be here, [for me being here.] What's next? And I think that's what I'm doing with this project. It's like a deeper journey to show people who I am, where I come from. What I can say is that I really feel proud about my people, about my country, about my culture, and about how they be [are] resisting and people who inspire the new generation to keep fighting and keep cuidando, preservando lo que somos.

STRUGGLES

Bad [Bunny](#) then spoke about his personality and some of the struggles and doubts he has at this stage of his life. **Bad [Bunny](#):** I'm a very emotional person and sometimes I [overthink](#) everything. So I'm just learning to not to think too much and just trust in life, in God, in the process and enjoy the moment. But now that I'm thirty, people start to ask you like, "When you're going to marry? When you're going to have kids?" And there's a lot of thoughts that start to come to your mind. And I'm about to turn ten years in the industry, and that's fucking crazy. [Cause](#) sometimes I feel that I'm... I'm a [rookie](#).

IMMIGRATION

In "DeBÍ TirAR Más FOToS", Bad [Bunny pays homage](#) to the story of immigrants from Puerto Rico and the Latin community, with the [opening track](#) named NUEVAYoL, imitating the way in which New York is often pronounced by those with a Puerto Rican accent. In fact, while most of the album was recorded in Puerto Rico's capital, San Juan, he also recorded parts in New York. **Bad [Bunny](#):** There's a couple [of] songs that I recorded in Nueva York. I said, I don't want to record any song out from [outside] Puerto Rico. The only place that I'm going to record beside Puerto Rico is going to be New York. So I was staying in this house and they had like an office and we went to a Puerto Rican souvenirs shop. We filled the whole of it, like there was like two thousand flags and coquí and it was like the most Nuyorican place ever and I record [recorded] a couple songs there I think like two, maybe three, but the whole album was made here.

UPBEAT MESSAGE

[Lifting people's mood](#) is a priority for Bad [Bunny](#), and he hopes that his music will allow listeners to feel more [joyful](#), no matter [their](#) life circumstances or the state of international affairs. **Bad [Bunny](#):** That's always the goal, like bring happiness and bring joy to people, no matter what is happening around the world, no matter how fucked up we are. That's one of the reasons that I create and I make music, 'cause I feel that there's nothing bad happening in the world and in my life when I'm creating music. I hope that people who feel that to also when they listen to my music, like, "Fuck, I don't know. I had a bad day today, but now I'm listening to this and I feel better."

SUPER BOWL HALFTIME CONTROVERSY

Bad [Bunny](#) received huge media attention when he was selected as the [headline act](#) at the Apple Music Super Bowl LX Halftime Show on 8 February 2026. This was a controversial choice, not only because Bad [Bunny](#) performs in Spanish, but also because he made the decision to exclude the US from his 2025-2026 tour for fear of ICE (Immigration and [Customs Enforcement](#)) [raids](#) at his concerts. The announcement was met with considerable [backlash](#), with a petition to replace him with American country music singer George Strait collecting over one hundred thousand signatures. Even Trump [spoke out](#) against the decision, calling the Latin star "a ridiculous choice" for the Super Bowl Halftime Show, while also admitting that he had never heard of him. Bad [Bunny](#), however, expressed immense pride and joy at having been selected to headline the major event, stating, "What I'm feeling goes beyond myself. It's for those who came before me and ran [countless](#) yards so I could come in and score a touchdown... this is for my people, my culture, and our history."

Glossary

- **heritage** = eredità
- **Customs** = dogane, frontiere
- **backlash** = reazione negativa
- **Bunny** = coniglietto
- **blends** = mescolare
- **token** = simbolo
- **mind-blowing** = sbalorditivo
- **'Cause** = perché (abbreviazione di 'because')
- **overthink** = pensare troppo
- **headline act** = artista principale
- **True to form** = fedele al suo stile, come sempre
- **purpose** = scopo
- **rookie** = principiante
- **Lifting people's mood** = tirare su di morale
- **joyful** = allegri
- **Enforcement** = applicazione (della legge)
- **countless** = innumerevoli
- **statement** = dichiarazione
- **unincorporated territory** = territorio non incorporato
- **pays homage** = rendere omaggio
- **opening track** = brano di apertura dell'album
- **raids** = retate
- **spoke out** = esporsi
- **release date** = data di uscita
- **heir** = erede